

India's response to the recent unrest in Tibet has been dignified and measured. Those who advocate a tougher attitude towards China forget that the two neighbours, despite differences, are good friends.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Serial Killer

While most of the serials that are being thrust upon the poor Indian audiences are regressive and incoherent, it is still an enigma how millions of housewives all over the country cannot wait to watch the next episode ("Stop or the Viewers will Shoot", March 31).

AMITABH THAKUR, *Lucknow*

Weak Couture

From sliding outfits to slipping and tripping over heels, the India Fashion Week has fallen quite low, making India fall, thus, making it weak ("And They all Fall Down", March 31). One might as well call it the India Fall Weak.

MANISHA GUPTA, *Delhi*

In Good Faith

The law has taken its course and it is heartening to see that the guilty (here an IPS officer) has been brought to the book ("Justice at Last", March 31). This decision has reaffirmed the common man's faith in the judiciary.

B. UMAKKANTH, *Hyderabad*

In Bad Taste

Instead of hankering for cheap publicity by saying that he was an Indian spy in Pakistan, Kashmir Singh should have shown military discipline and kept quiet ("Hanging by a Thread", March 31). One hopes that

his comments do not jeopardise Sarabjit Singh's mercy petition.

ASHOK KUMAR GHOSH, *on e-mail*

Married to Change

It was fascinating to go through the article "Netrimony" (March 24). The write-up points towards the mini-revolution that has resulted in a paradigm-shift in society where people are trying to overcome the barriers of caste, language and social preju-

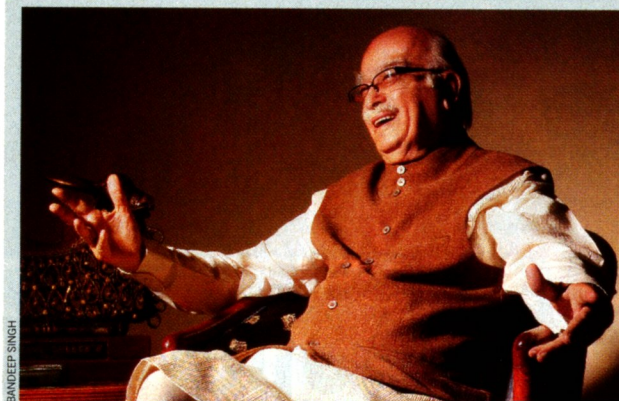
ices to find a suitable life partner.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA, *Mysore*

The Internet gives people the freedom to choose their life partner without useless interference of family members. However, net enabled mate search may facilitate extra-marital affairs since an easy mode of communication with members of the opposite sex usually throws up tempting options.

PUNEET MADHOK, *Mumbai*

ONE FOR THE BOOKS



Penning an autobiography even while being an incumbent in active politics is indeed laudable especially when the writer in question is an astute politician who is aware of the scrutiny his written word will invite. ("Testament of an Unrepentant Nationalist", March 24).

UDAY R. POWAR, *Aurangabad*

It is amusing but at times disturbing to see the hype associated with Advani's book *My Country, My Life*. His double standards and hypocrisy are typical of the man. The assiduous build-up of the iron-man image falls to pieces when one looks at his tenure as the country's home minister which was marred by the Gujarat riots.

P.N. NAGARAJAN, *Secundrabad*

Advani's autobiography should have been titled "My Life, Your Country" as an ode to his selfishness.

SHANTI SWARUP, *Chennai*

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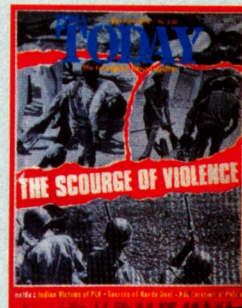
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Years Ago in India Today

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Shrouded in Mystery

Prime Minister Morarji Desai dropped a bombshell in Parliament last month when he disclosed that India and USA had collaborated "at top level" to plant a nuclear-powered spy device on the slopes of Nanda Devi. There were two joint Indo-US expeditions, the first in 1965, and the second in 1967. The aim was apparently to



snoop on the goings-on in Sinkiang across the border, but Morarji Desai did not say how far the mission was successful.

However, doubts remain. Two top individuals involved on the Indian side of the joint Indo-American "project" died under suspicious conditions within days of each other. Lal Bahadur Shastri, who was prime minister at the time of the first CIA plant as well as in charge of atomic energy died in Tashkent on January 11, 1966. Homi Bhabha, chairman of the Atomic Energy Commission disappeared in an alrcrash 13 days later.

—Jay Dubeshi